

This short scripture, known in Sanskrit by a title corresponding to something li

Toh 782 · Derge Kangyur

This short scripture, known in Sanskrit by a title corresponding to something like the Sarva-durgati-pariśodhana-dhāraṇī and referred to in Tibetan through the source text as the incantation for thoroughly clearing away all bad rebirths, is a dhāraṇī text centered on homage to the Tathāgata who purifies beings from unfortunate states of rebirth. It presents a mantra formula—invoking purification, cleansing of all misdeeds, and removal of karmic obscurations—that practitioners are to recite or comprehend fully. The text promises that anyone, whether son or daughter of noble family, who grasps the letters, words, and names of this dhāraṇī will gain the ability to recall countless past lives, purify karmic obscurations, swiftly attain irreversibility on the path to awakening, and accumulate inexhaustible merit until reaching enlightenment itself. As Toh 782 in the Kangyur, this work belongs to the class of dhāraṇī literature, brief protective or purificatory incantations attributed to the word of the Buddha and preserved among the canonical scriptures.

Homage to the Tathāgata, Arhat, Perfectly Completed Buddha who thoroughly clears away all bad rebirths (durgati).

Tadyathā: oṃ śodhani viśodhane mama sarva-pāpaṃ viśodhane śuddhe viśuddhe sarva-karma-āvaraṇa-viśuddhe svāhā.

Whatever son or daughter of noble family fully grasps all the letters, words, or names of this dhāraṇī will recall their lives for fourteen hundred thousand eons. All obscurations of karma will also be purified, and they will quickly attain irreversibility as well. Until reaching the very essence of awakening, their merit will never be exhausted.

This completes the dhāraṇī called "Thoroughly Purifying All Bad Rebirths."

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are transliterated Sanskrit given in Tibetan phonetic rendering; they are reproduced here in standardized Sanskrit transliteration rather than translated, per convention for dhāraṇī/mantra material. "Fourteen hundred thousand eons" renders bskal pa 'bum phrag bcu bzhi (i.e., 1,400,000 eons).
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Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.